

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Peacemaking and Its Consequences — The Treaty of Versailles and the Fourteen Points, 1918–1919

US.26 — Explain the reasons for U.S. entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

US.29 — Analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson’s contributions to the Treaty of Versailles, including the Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Read the three documents below. Then write a well-organized essay addressing the following question: To what extent did the Treaty of Versailles fulfill, compromise, or betray Wilson's Fourteen Points, and what were the consequences of those compromises for world peace? Your essay must: — Apply HIPP or SOAPS analysis to at least two documents — Use all three documents as evidence — Incorporate outside knowledge of the Paris Peace Conference and subsequent events — Construct a clear, defensible argument

The sources

Document 1

President Woodrow Wilson, Fourteen Points Address to Congress, January 8, 1918 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain (Points I, V, XIV selected)

“I. Open covenants of peace, openly arrived at, after which there shall be no private international understandings of any kind... V. A free, open-minded, and absolutely impartial adjustment of all colonial claims... XIV. A general association of nations must be formed under specific covenants for the purpose of affording mutual guarantees of political independence and territorial integrity to great and small states alike.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

Treaty of Versailles, Article 231 ('War Guilt Clause'), June 28, 1919 — Avalon Project, Yale Law School, public domain

“Germany accepts the responsibility of Germany and her allies for causing all the loss and damage to which the Allied and Associated Governments and their nationals have been subjected as a consequence of the war imposed upon them by the aggression of Germany and her allies.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 3

Senator Henry Cabot Lodge, Speech on the Treaty of Versailles and Article X of the League Covenant, August 12, 1919 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain

“I have always loved but one flag... but I have loved America with an undivided heart, and I cannot share that devotion, cannot give affection to the mongrel banner invented for a league... I have loved but one flag and I am not prepared to put American boys under the command of some foreign general, or to bind America to go to war at the behest of other nations without the consent of Congress... Article X I consider the most dangerous obligation that has ever been submitted to the Senate.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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hear it?

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the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

DOCUMENT 3 Senator Henry Cabot Lodge, Speech on the Treaty of Versailles and Article X of the League Covenant, August 12, 1919 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., Republic or Empire (1899), public domain, public domain: "I have always loved but one flag... but I have loved America with an undivided heart, and I cannot share that devotion, cannot give affection to the mongrel banner invented for a league... I have loved but one flag and I am not prepared to put American boys under the command of some foreign general, or to bind America to go to war at the behest of other nations without the consent of Congress... Article X I consider the most dangerous obligation that has ever been submitted to the Senate."

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Complex, specific thesis arguing the multi-layered betrayal of Wilson's vision (Allied modifications, Senate rejection) and linking these to consequences (German resentment, Hitler's rise, League failure). HIPPSOAPS of at least two documents with specific, accurate content — especially Wilson's intended audience of Germany and occupied peoples (Doc 1) and the Article 231 legal mechanism for reparations (Doc 2). Extensive outside knowledge. Long-term consequences developed specifically.
5	Advanced. Clear thesis. HIPPSOAPS of at least two documents accurately. Good outside knowledge. Addresses the betrayal and consequences but may not achieve full cross-document synthesis.
4	Proficient. Clear thesis. Uses all three documents. HIPPSOAPS of at least one document. Some outside knowledge. Coherent argument.
3	Adequate. Thesis present. Uses two or more documents. Some HIPPSOAPS elements. Limited outside knowledge.
2	Developing. Weak thesis. Uses documents without framework analysis.
1	Beginning. No thesis. Minimal document use.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: — Doc 1 (Wilson's 14 Points): Note that Point V addresses colonial self-determination — the Paris Conference largely ignored this for non-European peoples; Point XIV established the League; historical context = Wilson hoped Germany would accept an armistice based on the 14 Points, which it did in November 1918 — only to find the treaty imposed punitive terms. — Doc 2 (War Guilt Clause): Note this contradicts Wilson's 'peace without victory' vision; reparations were set at \$33 billion (1921 London Schedule); the clause provided Hitler with his central propaganda tool — the 'war guilt lie'; Point of View = Clemenceau's revanchism. — Doc 3 (Lodge): Note Lodge was NOT an isolationist per se — he supported an amended league; Article X objection was about congressional war powers; Wilson's refusal to accept any reservations led to the defeat; Lodge-Wilson personal animosity as a complicating factor. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Paris Peace Conference participants (Wilson, Clemenceau, Lloyd George, Orlando); 'Big Four'; Wilson's stroke (October 1919); Senate rejection (November 1919, March 1920); German reparations (\$33 billion); territorial losses; League without U.S.; Weimar instability; Hitler's exploitation of the War Guilt Clause; League failures in 1930s (Manchuria 1931, Ethiopia 1935–36).

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

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